PROSPER AWUNI

Senior Cyber Security Engineer | Enterprise Security, Cloud and Hybrid Environments

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PROFESSIONAL PROFILE

I am a Senior Cyber Security Engineer with more than five years of experience running, tuning and improving complex enterprise security tooling stacks across cloud, on-premises and hybrid infrastructure. I hold the Certified Information Systems Security Professional (CISSP) certification alongside Microsoft security certifications and bring deep hands-on experience as the lead security expert on Information Technology (IT) and business projects, providing technical security assurance across cloud services including Infrastructure as a Service (IaaS), Platform as a Service (PaaS) and Software as a Service (SaaS). My background covers the full enterprise security lifecycle, including security control reviews, penetration testing coordination, purple teaming activities, threat hunting, and incident response. I have a strong record delivering large-scale Identity and Access Management (IAM), Endpoint Detection and Response (EDR), and Security Information and Event Management (SIEM) programmes, and I am highly effective at translating technical risk into clear stakeholder guidance.

CORE SKILLS AND TECHNICAL STACK

- **Enterprise Security Tooling:** CrowdStrike Falcon (EDR, NG-SIEM, Prevent, Insight, Discover), Microsoft Defender for Endpoint (MDE), Microsoft Defender for Identity (MDI), Microsoft 365 Defender, Microsoft Sentinel with Kusto Query Language (KQL)
- **Cloud and Hybrid Security:** Microsoft Azure security controls (IaaS, PaaS, SaaS), Azure Active Directory (Azure AD) / Entra ID, Conditional Access, Multi-Factor Authentication (MFA), cloud workload protection
- **Vulnerability Management and Assurance:** Pentera Breach and Attack Simulation (BAS), Tenable.io, AppCheck, Nessus; end-to-end penetration test coordination, purple teaming, and remediation tracking
- **Privileged Access and Identity:** BeyondTrust Privileged Access Management (PAM), Single Sign-On (SSO), Conditional Access policy design and enforcement
- **Endpoint and Device Management:** Tanium, Microsoft Intune Mobile Device Management (MDM) and Mobile Application Management (MAM)
- **Perimeter and Network Security:** Check Point Harmony Firewall, Mimecast email security gateway, Intrusion Detection System (IDS) and Intrusion Prevention System (IPS) management
- **Incident Response:** NIST SP 800-61, MITRE ATT&CK adversary mapping, threat hunting, digital forensics triage
- **Scripting and Automation:** PowerShell scripting, Security Orchestration, Automation and Response (SOAR) automation
- **Frameworks and Standards:** NIST Cybersecurity Framework (CSF), Centre for Internet Security (CIS) Controls, ISO 27001, Cyber Essentials Plus, MITRE ATT&CK

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

University of the Arts London (UAL) *March 2025 - Present*

Senior Cyber Security Analyst / Engineer

- Act as the lead technical security expert for an 8,000-user institution, providing specialist security guidance on all major IT and business projects, from initial design through to delivery, covering cloud-native, hybrid, and on-premises architectures.
- Run, tune and continuously improve the enterprise security tooling stack, including CrowdStrike Falcon EDR and NG-SIEM, Microsoft Sentinel, Microsoft Defender for Endpoint, Microsoft Defender for Identity, and Microsoft 365 Defender, to maximise detection fidelity and operational efficiency.
- Lead the university's vulnerability management and penetration testing programme using Pentera BAS, Tenable.io, AppCheck, and Nessus; coordinate external penetration test engagements, manage finding prioritisation and track remediation to closure with infrastructure and development teams.
- Conduct purple teaming exercises using Pentera Breach and Attack Simulation, validating detection and response capabilities against MITRE ATT&CK adversary techniques and feeding lessons learned back into the detection

engineering cycle.

- Execute security control reviews and technical assurance checks across cloud services (Azure IaaS, PaaS, SaaS), identity platforms, and on-premises infrastructure, ensuring alignment with the Centre for Internet Security (CIS) Controls and ISO 27001 requirements.
- Design and maintain Conditional Access policies, MFA enrolment, and SSO integrations in Azure AD / Entra ID, enforcing zero-trust identity principles across the institution's application landscape.
- Administer BeyondTrust PAM, governing privileged account lifecycle, session recording, and periodic access certification across critical systems.
- Manage Microsoft Intune MDM/MAM for device compliance and mobile application governance; maintain endpoint security baselines using Tanium.
- Lead incident response activities in line with NIST SP 800-61, containing and eradicating threats across endpoint, identity, network, and cloud environments, and producing post-incident reports with root-cause analysis and corrective recommendations.
- Contribute to the university's security certification programmes, including Cyber Essentials Plus, and produce risk reporting for senior leadership and governance committees.

University of the Arts London (UAL) *March 2022 - March 2025*

Cyber Security Analyst, Cyber Security and Identity

- Provided security assurance on IT and infrastructure change projects, reviewing designs and configurations for alignment with security policy, Cyber Essentials Plus controls, and ISO 27001.
- Managed SIEM alert triage and threat hunting using Microsoft Sentinel with KQL and CrowdStrike Falcon, investigating anomalous behaviour across endpoint, identity, and network telemetry.
- Supported configuration and ongoing improvement of the EDR platform (CrowdStrike Falcon), tuning detections to reduce false positives while maintaining coverage of threat actor techniques.
- Administered Azure AD / Entra ID identity and access controls, including Conditional Access policies, MFA rollout, and SSO federation across enterprise applications.
- Assisted with vulnerability scanning and patch management using Tenable.io and Nessus; liaised with infrastructure teams to validate and track remediation of identified vulnerabilities.
- Supported BeyondTrust PAM administration, onboarding privileged accounts and conducting periodic access reviews.
- Maintained IDS/IPS rules and reviewed network security logs from Check Point Harmony Firewall; escalated and investigated anomalous network activity.
- Supported the university's Cyber Essentials Plus certification programme, documenting security controls and coordinating remediation of gaps identified during the assessment.

HICX Solutions Ltd (SaaS / FinTech) *February 2021 - March 2022*

IT Engineer: Security, Quality and Infrastructure

- Managed security operations for a cloud-first SaaS FinTech company, administering endpoint security, identity and access controls, and cloud security monitoring across Azure-hosted infrastructure.
- Administered IAM controls including MFA and SSO, protecting access to cloud-hosted platforms and internal business systems in a SaaS environment.
- Performed vulnerability assessments and assisted with remediation tracking; maintained endpoint security tooling and enforced patching compliance across the technology estate.
- Supported ISO 27001-aligned compliance audits, contributing to control documentation and evidence collection.
- Provided escalation support for security-related incidents, conducting root-cause analysis and implementing corrective controls to prevent recurrence.

KEY ACHIEVEMENTS

- Built and operationalised an enterprise-wide security tooling programme across 8,000 users, integrating CrowdStrike Falcon EDR, Microsoft Sentinel, and the full Microsoft Defender suite to deliver a unified detection and response capability across endpoint, identity, and cloud surfaces.
- Established the university's first formal vulnerability management and Breach and Attack Simulation programme using Pentera BAS, Tenable.io, and AppCheck, providing continuous risk visibility and driving measured reductions in critical vulnerabilities across the estate.

- Led the university's Cyber Essentials Plus certification, coordinating cross-functional technical remediation and achieving a successful first-time pass.
- Implemented and enforced a zero-trust identity strategy through Azure AD Conditional Access, MFA and SSO improvements, significantly reducing identity-based attack risk across the institution's cloud application portfolio.
- Designed and delivered a BeyondTrust PAM governance framework for privileged accounts, eliminating unmanaged administrative credentials and providing full session-level audit capability for critical system access.

EDUCATION

- M.Sc. Environmental and Resource Engineering
- B.Sc. Chemical Engineering

CERTIFICATIONS

- Certified Information Systems Security Professional (CISSP)
- CompTIA Security+
- Microsoft Certified Solutions Associate (MCSA)
- CompTIA A+
- Google IT Support Professional Certificate

References available on request | Hybrid (UK)